

FASCINATING FACTS

As your belly grows, your body takes on many interesting changes, some of which are absolutely incredible.

23%

This is the amount of extra blood pumped into your uterus while you're pregnant.

30–50%

By 28 weeks your cardio output has increased by 30–50 percent.

20 in (50 cm)

This is the average length that the umbilical cord will grow to during a woman's pregnancy.

45%

By week 16, your body will contain 45 percent more blood than it did before you were pregnant.

99.5°F (37.5°C)

The temperature of the amniotic fluid that surrounds your baby.

50%

You breathe 50 percent more deeply in pregnancy.

A CLOSER LOOK

Your growing belly

Being pregnant is amazing. Not only does your body change to meet the demands of growing a baby inside you, but also it all takes place in just 40 weeks. When you're pregnant your body creates a whole new organ, the placenta. Your heart and liver might grow in size to help meet the demands of your pregnancy and your uterus expands to accommodate your baby as she increases in size.



MOTHER
AT 12 WEEKS

MOTHER
AT 20 WEEKS

MOTHER
AT 28 WEEKS

MOTHER
AT 40 WEEKS

Growing belly As your uterus expands, so does your belly. The distance from the pubis to the top of the uterus is measured regularly from the second trimester of pregnancy. It's called the fundal height and is monitored as a marker of fetal growth. The measurement in centimeters usually matches the week of pregnancy that you're in.

1–4 weeks During the early weeks your baby is no bigger than the size of a grain of rice, so your uterus has only started on its growth spurt alongside your baby's. At four weeks, your uterus is pretty much the same size as before you were pregnant (about the size of a plum) and it measures between 2½–4 in (6–10cm) in length (not height, since it's horizontal).

GRAIN OF RICE

9–12 weeks At this stage your baby is about the size of a lime. You may notice that you've had more trips to the bathroom as your growing uterus puts pressure on your bladder. Frequent urination can also be a sign of a urinary infection, so speak to your doctor if you feel any pain. Your hands and feet may feel warmer because of the increased blood flow to your skin.



LIME